

Medication Management Policy

SECTIONS 1-3: PURPOSE, SCOPE & RESPONSIBILITIES

1 PURPOSE

To ensure the safe, effective, and accountable management of medications within Chosanta Management, covering prescribing, storage, administration, and disposal in accordance with legislative and best practice guidelines.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ Registered Nurses, HCAs, PICs, GPs, pharmacists, agency staff, and management
- ✓ Prescribing, ordering, receiving, storing, administering, documenting, auditing, and disposing of medications
- ✓ All prescribed, non-prescribed, controlled, and PRN (as-needed) medications

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Registered Provider:** Oversees policy; ensures governance systems, resources, and training
- ✓ **PIC:** Ensures correct protocols; reviews records/audits; reports errors; coordinates with pharmacy/GP
- ✓ **Registered Nurses:** Administer safely per NMBI guidelines; record immediately and accurately; report errors
- ✓ **HCAs:** Assist with self-administration if trained; monitor for side effects; do not administer unless delegated
- ✓ **GPs & Pharmacists:** Accurate legible prescriptions; medication reviews; compliance support
- ✓ **All Staff:** Report errors/risks; attend mandatory training; work within scope

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SECTION 4: PRESCRIBING & ORDERING

4 PRESCRIBING & ORDERING

4.1 Prescribing Standards:

- ✓ Only qualified registered medical practitioners may prescribe medication
- ✓ Prescriptions must be clear, legible, signed — include resident name, date, drug, dose, route, frequency, duration
- ✓ Verbal/telephone prescriptions not accepted except emergencies — must be documented and signed within 24 hours

4.2 Medication Reviews:

- ✓ Every 3–6 months, or sooner if clinically indicated or following significant health changes
- ✓ Conducted by GP and/or pharmacist in collaboration with nursing staff

4.3 Ordering Procedures:

- ✓ Ordered through approved community pharmacy with formal agreement
- ✓ Responsibility of Registered Nurse or PIC
- ✓ All orders checked against current prescription, recorded in Medication Order Log, signed and dated

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SECTION 5: ADMINISTRATION

5 ADMINISTRATION OF MEDICATION

Five Rights of Administration:

- ✓ Right Resident · Right Medication · Right Dose · Right Time · Right Route

5.2 Administration Process:

- ✓ MAR checked before and after each administration
- ✓ Medication administered directly to resident — never left unattended
- ✓ Documentation completed immediately after giving medication, not before

5.3 PRN (As Needed) Medications:

- ✓ Clearly prescribed with maximum dose and frequency
- ✓ Reason for administration and outcome documented in notes and MAR

5.4 Covert Administration:

- ✓ Only permitted after full MDT assessment, documented covert care plan, and where resident lacks capacity
- ✓ Must be authorised in writing and reviewed regularly

5.5 Refusal of Medication:

- ✓ Respect resident's choice unless they lack capacity
- ✓ Document refusal in MAR; inform GP and PIC if repeated or serious



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SECTIONS 6-7: STORAGE & DOCUMENTATION

6 STORAGE OF MEDICATION

- ✓ **General:** Locked cabinet/trolley in designated room with limited access; correct temperatures per manufacturer
- ✓ **Refrigerated:** Dedicated medication fridge; temperature checked daily and recorded; original packaging
- ✓ **Controlled Drugs:** Double-locked CD cabinet per Misuse of Drugs Regulations; CD register completed for every administration, signed by two staff, audited weekly
- ✓ **Expired/Discontinued:** Clearly marked, separated from in-use stock, returned to pharmacist and logged

7 RECORDING & DOCUMENTATION

- ✓ **MAR Sheet:** Maintained for each resident — time, dose, route, initials, omission/refusal reasons, PRN outcomes; updated in real time, reviewed weekly
- ✓ **Medication Error Log:** Type of error, date/time, actions taken, staff involved, whether GP/family informed
- ✓ **CD Register:** Entries in ink immediately after administration; signed by two staff; balanced end of each shift
- ✓ **Retention:** All medication records retained minimum 7 years, available for HIQA inspection

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SECTIONS 8–11: ERRORS, DISPOSAL, REVIEW & TRAINING

8 MEDICATION ERRORS

- ✓ Ensure resident safety first; contact GP/emergency services if needed; inform PIC immediately
- ✓ Document in Error Log and resident notes; all errors reported regardless of harm
- ✓ PIC investigates, initiates corrective actions, informs GP/family/regulators as required
- ✓ Errors reviewed at governance meetings; may trigger policy updates, training, or enhanced supervision

9 DISPOSAL OF MEDICATION

- ✓ Remove expired, discontinued, damaged, or unidentifiable medications from active use
- ✓ Store awaiting disposal in locked, labelled container separate from in-use stock
- ✓ Return to nominated pharmacist; complete disposal log (name, medication, quantity, reason, signatures)
- ✓ **Controlled Drugs:** Two staff signatures; witnessed destruction by pharmacist; separate CD disposal record

10 REVIEW & AUDIT

- ✓ Policy reviewed annually or following new guidance, incidents, or audit gaps
- ✓ Monthly medication audits: MAR completion, storage, PRN/CD logs, disposal logs, error documentation
- ✓ PIC conducts periodic spot checks during medication rounds

11 STAFF TRAINING & COMPETENCY

- ✓ Mandatory HIQA-compliant training before administering any medication; refreshed every 2 years
- ✓ Practical competency assessment: administration, MAR charts, CD handling, storage, ordering, disposal
- ✓ PIC signs off each staff member's competency; training logs maintained by management

Medication Administration Record (MAR)

TEMPLATE

Resident Name: _____
DOB: _____
PPSN: _____
Medical Card No.: _____
Month / Year: _____

MEDICATION LIST

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

DAILY ADMINISTRATION LOG

Date: _____
Time: _____
Medication: _____
Dose: _____
Staff Initials: _____
Comments: _____

Medication Recording Forms

DISPOSAL LOG & CONTROLLED DRUG REGISTER



MEDICATION DISPOSAL LOG

Date of Disposal:	
Resident Name:	
Medication Name:	
Dosage / Quantity:	
Reason: ☐ Expired ☐ Discontinued ☐ Refused	
Returned to (Pharmacy):	
Staff Signature:	
Witness Signature:	



CONTROLLED DRUG REGISTER

Resident Name:	
Medication:	
Prescriber:	
Date Received:	
Quantity Received:	
Shift Records:	
Date / Time:	
Quantity Given:	
Balance Remaining:	
Staff 1 Signature:	
Staff 2 Signature:	
Weekly Audit Check (PIC):	